

Pygame!



A simple Pygame example

```
1  import pygame
2
3  pygame.init()
4  screen = pygame.display.set_mode((640, 480))
5
6  color = [(0,0,0), (255,255,255)]
7  running = True
8
9  while running:
10     for event in pygame.event.get():
11         if event.type == pygame.QUIT:
12             running = False
13         screen.fill(color[0])
14         pygame.display.flip()
15         if event.type == pygame.KEYDOWN:
16             color[0], color[1] = color[1], color[0]
```

01-simple_pygame.py

16

17

What each element does: **Import and Initialize**

```
1 import pygame
2
3 pygame.init()
4 screen = pygame.display.set_mode((640, 480))
5
6 color = [(0,0,0), (255,255,255)]
7 running = True
8
9 while running:
10     for event in pygame.event.get():
11         if event.type == pygame.QUIT:
12             running = False
13         screen.fill(color[0])
14         pygame.display.flip()
15         if event.type == pygame.KEYDOWN:
16             color[0], color[1] = color[1], color[0]
```

to import the Pygame module

to set up / initialize Pygame

01-simple_pygame.py

16

17

A simple Pygame example

```
1 import pygame
2
3 pygame.init()
4 screen = pygame.display.set_mode((640, 480))
5
6 color = [(0,0,0), (255,255,255)]
7 running = True
8
9 while running:
10     for event in pygame.event.get():
11         if event.type == pygame.QUIT:
12             running = False
13         screen.fill(color[0])
14         pygame.display.flip()
15         if event.type == pygame.KEYDOWN:
16             color[0], color[1] = color[1], color[0]
```

01-simple_pygame.py

16

17

What each element does: **Setting Window & Screen**

```
screen = pygame.display.set_mode((640, 480))
```

initializes a **window** with dimensions 640×480 and returns the **screen object**.

Everything to be displayed needs to be drawn on the `screen`.

A simple Pygame example

```
1  import pygame
2
3  pygame.init()
4  screen = pygame.display.set_mode((640, 480))
5
6  color = [(0,0,0), (255,255,255)]
7  running = True
8
9  while running:
10     for event in pygame.event.get():
11         if event.type == pygame.QUIT:
12             running = False
13         screen.fill(color[0])
14         pygame.display.flip()
15         if event.type == pygame.KEYDOWN:
16             color[0], color[1] = color[1], color[0]
```

01-simple_pygame.py

16

17

What each element does: **The Main Loop**

```
1 running = True while
2 running:
3     for event in pygame.event.get():
4         if event.type == pygame.QUIT:
5             running = False
6         if event.type == pygame.KEYDOWN:
7             color[0], color[1] = color[1], color[0]
```

is the **main loop** of the game.

- ▶ listen to events (closing game, pressing keys) → respond
- ▶ proceed the game
- ▶ draw on the screen
- ▶ stop when done

Drawing

Drawing on the screen

Filling the screen with a color:

```
1 blue = (0,0,255)
2 screen.fill(blue)
3 pygame.display.flip()
```

After all drawing is done, call `display.flip()` to **update** the display.

Use `pygame.draw` to draw geometric shapes. A circle:

```
1 red = (255,0,0)
2 # position (320,240), radius = 50
3 pygame.draw.circle(screen, red, (320,240), 50)
```

Drawing on the screen

Geometric shapes available for `pygame.draw`:

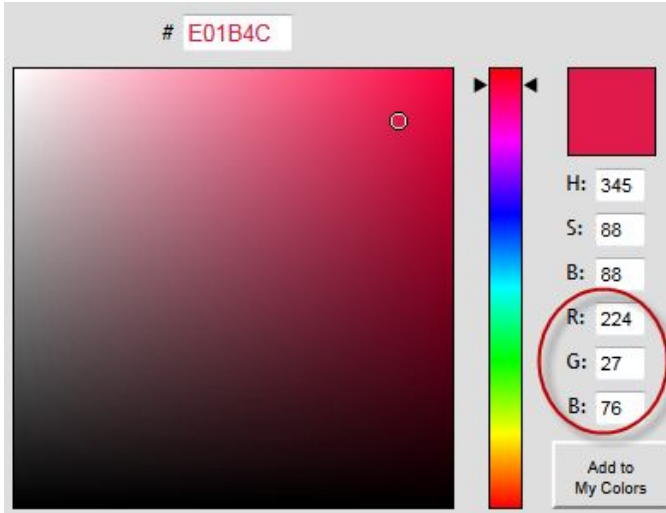
- `circle(Surface, color, pos, radius, width=0)`
- `polygon(Surface, color, pointlist, width=0)`
- `line(Surface, color, start, end, width= 1)`
- `rect(Surface, color, Rect, width=0)`
- `ellipse(Surface, color, Rect, width=0)`

```
1 red = (255,0,0)
2 pygame.draw.line(screen, red, (10,50), (30,50), 10)
```

Drawing on the screen - **Colors**

Defining a color

```
gray = (200, 200, 200)  
 #(red, green, blue)
```



picker.com:

Red
Green
Blue

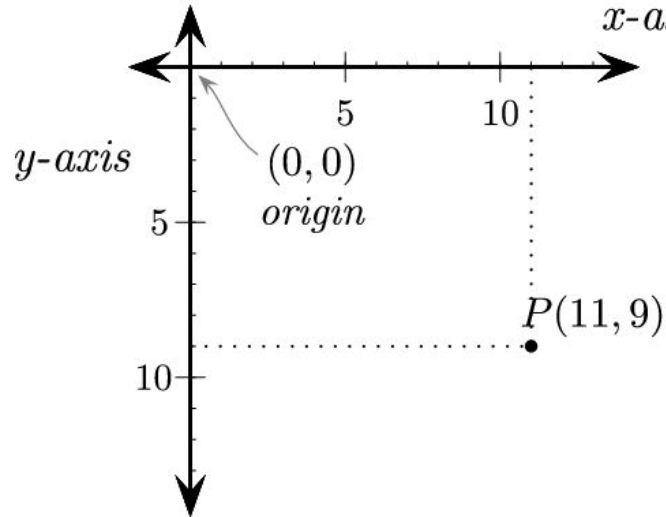
Drawing on the screen - **Positions**

Defining a position:

$$P = (11, 9)$$

#(x-axis, y-axis)

To the reference coordinate system



Drawing on the screen - **Rects**

`pygame.Rect(left, top, width, height)`

to create a Rect (i.e., rectangle)

```
1 box = pygame.Rect(10, 10, 100, 40)
2 pygame.draw.rect(screen, blue, box)
3 #draws at (10,10) rectangle of width 100, height 40
```

A full drawing example

```
1  import pygame
2
3  pygame.init()
4  screen = pygame.display.set_mode((640, 480))
5
6  white = (255,255,255)
7  blue = (0,0,255)
8
9  running = True
10 while running:
11     for event in pygame.event.get():
12         if event.type == pygame.QUIT:
13             screen.fill(white)
14             running = False
15             pygame.draw.circle(screen, blue, (320,240), 100)
16             # position (320,240), radius = 100
17             pygame.display.flip()
```

04-drawing.py.

User Input

Events

get all events in Pygame's event queue

```
pygame.event.get()
```

usually used as

```
1 for event in pygame.event.get():  
2     if event.type == YourEvent:  
3         react to your event()
```


Event types

Some of the **most important** event types are:

`pygame.QUIT`

`pygame.KEYDOWN`

`pygame.KEYUP`

`pygame.USEREVENT`

Events

React to KEYDOWN event:

```
1 while running:
2     for event in pygame.event.get():
3         if event.type == KEYDOWN:
4             react_to_key()
```

Which key? → if event type is KEYDOWN or KEYUP event has attribute **key**.

```
1 for event in pygame.event.get(): if
2     event.type == KEYDOWN:
3         if event.key == K_ESCAPE: running
4             = False
```

Pygame Keys

Some of the most important keys are:

`K_RETURN` `K_SPACE`

`K_ESCAPE`

`K_UP`, `K_DOWN`, `K_LEFT`, `K_RIGHT`

`K_a`, `K_b`, ...

`K_0`, `K_1`, ...

Full list of keys: <http://www.pygame.org/docs/ref/key.html>

Getting continuous input

`KEYDOWN` is a unique event.

```
key = pygame.key.get_pressed()
```

to get keys currently pressed.

```
if key[pygame.K_UP]: move_up()
```

to check and react on a specific key.

A user input example

```
1 color = [0,0,0]
2
3 while running:
4     for event in pygame.event.get():
5         if event.type == pygame.QUIT:
6             running = False
7         if event.type == KEYDOWN and event.key == K_SPACE:
8             color = [0,0,0]
9             keys = pygame.key.get_pressed()
10            if keys[K_UP]:
11                color = [(rgb+1)%256 for rgb in color]
12            screen.fill(color) pygame.display.flip()
```

15 05-user_input.py

Pygame's Clock

Limiting the frames per second

```
clock = pygame.time.Clock()
```

to initialize the clock.

In your main loop call

```
clock.tick(60) #limit to 60 fps
```

Clock example

```
1  clock = pygame.time.Clock()
2
3  while running:
4      for event in pygame.event.get():
5          if event.type == pygame.QUIT:
6              running = False
7          if event.type == KEYDOWN and event.key == K_SPACE:
8              color = [0,0,0]
10             keys = pygame.key.get_pressed()
11             if keys[K_UP]:
12                 color = [(rgb+1)%256 for rgb in color]
13
14             screen.fill(color)
15             pygame.display.flip()
16             clock.tick(60)
17
```

06-clock.py

Game Events

Sprites

Pygame's **sprite class** gives convenient options for handling interactive graphical objects.

If you want to draw **and** move (or manipulate) an object, make it a sprite.

Sprites

- can be grouped together

- are easily drawn to a surface (even as a group!) have

- an update method that can be modified have collision

- detection

Basic Sprite

```
1 class SpriteExample(pygame.sprite.Sprite):  
2  
3     def __init__(self): pygame.sprite.Sprite.__init  
4         (self)  
5  
6         self.image = #image  
7         self.rect = #rect  
8  
9     def update(self): pass
```

Sprite from a local image

```
1 class SpriteExample(pygame.sprite.Sprite):  
2  
3     def __init__(self): pygame.sprite.Sprite.__init__  
4         (self)  
5  
6         self.image = pygame.image.load('local_img.png') self.rect =  
7         self.image.get_rect()  
8         self.rect.topleft = (80,120)  
9  
10    def update(self): pass  
11
```

Self-drawn sprites: Rectangle

```
1 class Rectangle(pygame.sprite.Sprite):  
2  
3     def __init__(self): pygame.sprite.Sprite.__init__  
4         (self)  
5         self.image = pygame.Surface([200, 50])  
6         self.image.fill(blue)  
7         self.rect = self.image.get_rect() self.rect.top,  
8         self.rect.left = 100, 100  
9  
10 def update(self): pass
```

11

Sprites: A reminder about classes

```
1 class Rectangle(pygame.sprite.Sprite):  
2  
3     def __init__(self, color):  
4         pygame.sprite.Sprite.__init__(self)  
5         self.image = pygame.Surface([200, 50])  
6         self.image.fill(color)  
7         self.rect = self.image.get_rect()  
8         self.rect.top, self.rect.left = 100, 100  
9  
10  
11     def update(self):  
12         pass
```

```
1 white, blue = (255,255,255), (0,0,255)  
2  
3 white_rect = Rectangle(white)  
4 blue_rect = Rectangle(blue)
```

Sprite groups

```
new_sprite_group = pygame.sprite.Group(sprite1)
```

to create a new sprite group containing sprite `sprite1`.

```
new_sprite_group.add(sprite2)
```

to add another sprite later.

Group updating and drawing:

```
1  #inside main loop:  
2  
3  new_sprite_group.update() #game events  
4  new_sprite_group.draw()   #drawing
```

Framework for working with sprite groups

```
1 class NewSprite(pygame.sp...  
2     #defining a new sprite  
3  
4 newsprite = NewSprite()  
5 sprites = pygame.sprite.Group()  
6 sprites.add(newsprite)  
7  
8  
9 while running:  
10     for event in ...  
11         sprites.update() #game events  
12         sprites.draw()  
13         pygame.display.flip()
```


Sprite groups: Working example

```
1 class Circle(pygame.sprite.Sprite):
2     def __init__(self):
3         pygame.sprite.Sprite.__init__(self)
4         self.image = pygame.Surface([100, 100])
5         pygame.draw.circle(self.image, blue, (50, 50), 50)
6         self.rect = self.image.get_rect()
7         self.rect.center = [320, 240]
8
9     def draw.sprites():
10        screen.fill(white)
11        sprites.draw(screen)
12        pygame.display.flip()
13
14    circle = Circle()
15    sprites = pygame.sprite.Group(circle)
16
17    while running:
```

Acknowledgement

Initial slides by [Felix Hoffmann](#).

Modified by Minh Tran at University of Chicago for use in a summer pre-college course titled Creating Computer Games for Learning, Summer 2026.